

Bharti Airtel, Huawei, Tech Mahindra, ZTE Corporation, Nokia as well as loads of small and medium enterprises are in a hiring mode.

How to enter the communication chain?

Who can be a part of this thrilling wave sweeping across the country? Anyone who has anything to do with technology in his day-to-day life. Academicians, lawyers, MBAs, salespeople and PR people are needed just as badly as the techies who design and maintain the worldwide information network for the future. But to qualify for an engineering job, you need to be specialised either in electronics & communication engineering, computer science or electrical engineering.

On the technology side, there is room for degree holders, diploma holders or even candidates with part-time certification courses. You will find that most of the engineering jobs can be bucketed under some broad categories. For example, broadband network architects are people who provide IP network architecture solutions to clients for the next-generation network—a network based on IP, ATM and SONET.

Network and application test engineers integrate, verify and deploy a full-service, high-speed data network providing nationally distributed video, voice, local programming and data services.

Another important category is network management and architecture/system engineers. These people provide network management solutions to clients for currently planned deployments and next-generation network technologies. A position may include focus on all aspects of operations support. A combination of business, telecommunication and computer knowledge is optimal.

Wireless engineers develop potential wireless data applications, technology intelligence to identify and track wireless data products, and wireless

Considering that telecom is a booming industry even in times of the current economic recession, the demand for employable individuals is open. The types of firms that are engaged in recruiting are spread across, but not limited to, operators, integrators and vendors.”

—Pius Maria Prasad, director-human resource, Huawei Technologies India



data strategies. These also interact with vendors.

Bellheads are technocrats who understand switching, i.e., what takes place between the switch and the network. These don't need to write code, so ITI certificate or diploma is sufficient for this role.

What can you expect?

The high demand in telecom creates a minefield of opportunities for aspirants. These firms also pay well. The starting salary for freshers is Rs 300,000 to Rs 500,000 per annum. Customer facing jobs could fetch something between Rs 200,000 and Rs 300,000 per annum. The year-to-year salary hike is quite satisfactory in comparison with other sectors. As an engineer, you could choose to continue in the technology field, be a part of the technocommercial team or move to the business development aspect of the service.

“Under the technical career path, an individual who starts off as a software engineer can grow to the highest level of a chief technical officer (CTO). And under the managerial career path, he can grow to the level of a business line head,” says Prasad.

While recruiting, firms usually look at a combination of a consistent academic record and soft skills. Though the Indian academia is churning thousands of engineers per year, there is a significant gap between the need of the

industry and what the freshers bring to the table.

Of over 450,000 technical graduates churned out every year from engineering institutes, only 25 to 30 per cent are employable. This in itself is an indication of the ‘shortage’. To be fair, even this 25-30 per cent is not really ‘industry ready.’ In order to reduce the ‘gestation period’ of freshers, there is still a need for training and investment. They are not directly productive from day one.

So when you are looking at a possible employment opportunity, you need to know what's in demand there? Let's therefore focus on the industry expectations.

Where does communication begin?

“For optimising telecommunication applications, even professionals with science and engineering background entering the telecom industry, often require specialised training in theory and practice in order to properly handle different types of machines and instruments in various systems of telecom equipment, both in wired and wireless communication,” says K.S. Mittal, director-project at Mobile Communication (India).

As an aspiring professional, you better start from the base level. A basic telecommunication system consists of three elements: a transmitter that